

CASE CHRONICLES :

CASE STUDY CHALLENGE



What is STAGE?

STAGE, an OTT platform launched in October 2019 by Vinay Singhal, Shashank Vaishnav and Parveen Singhal.



“Stage’s slogan describes the passion and motivations of the team to build for the immense diversity of languages and dialects in India. Building quality content is the best bet to conserve our dialects and languages. With two dialects launched and dozens more to build, we are excited to be partners on this journey,”

It started with Haryanvi content and now boasts over 2,25,000 subscribers, adding 25,000 new subscribers monthly with a 30% month-on-month growth rate.

In June 2022, it expanded to Rajasthani content, gaining 10,000 subscribers.

The app has over 1.5 million downloads in Haryanvi alone and is available for free download.

It aims to preserve India's linguistic diversity through high-quality content and plans to reach 500 million users in the next five years.

By mid-2024, STAGE targets capturing 10% of video-consuming households in Haryana and Rajasthan.

By 2027, it aims to launch in 20 dialects, potentially reaching 200 million households.

Competitor Analysis

Evaluating key players in the regional content market to identify opportunities and strategic advantages.

OTT platform offering movies and web series in regional language

Founded in 2021

Located in Chandigarh

Company Stage - Seed

Dialects- Punjabi, Bhojpuri, Haryanavi & Rajasthani

CHAUPAL

STAGE surpasses Chaupal by targeting an more niche audience in rural India. This hyperlocal approach gives STAGE a unique advantage in deeply connecting with its users. It has better subscription plans along with an better app interface.

While Chaupal covers broader regional languages it doesn't have the same level of dialectal focus.

Video streaming OTT platform for watching content of North East India

Founded in 2020

Located in Imphal

Company Stage - Funding Raised

Dialects- of North East India



STAGE is more specialized compared to PurpledTv. It has cultivated a dedicated and loyal user base that appreciates the cultural specificity.

PurpleDTV might appeal more broadly but lacks the same depth of connection.

STAGE target a large population compared to PurpledTV.

Platform offering stream regional entertainment content

Founded in 2023

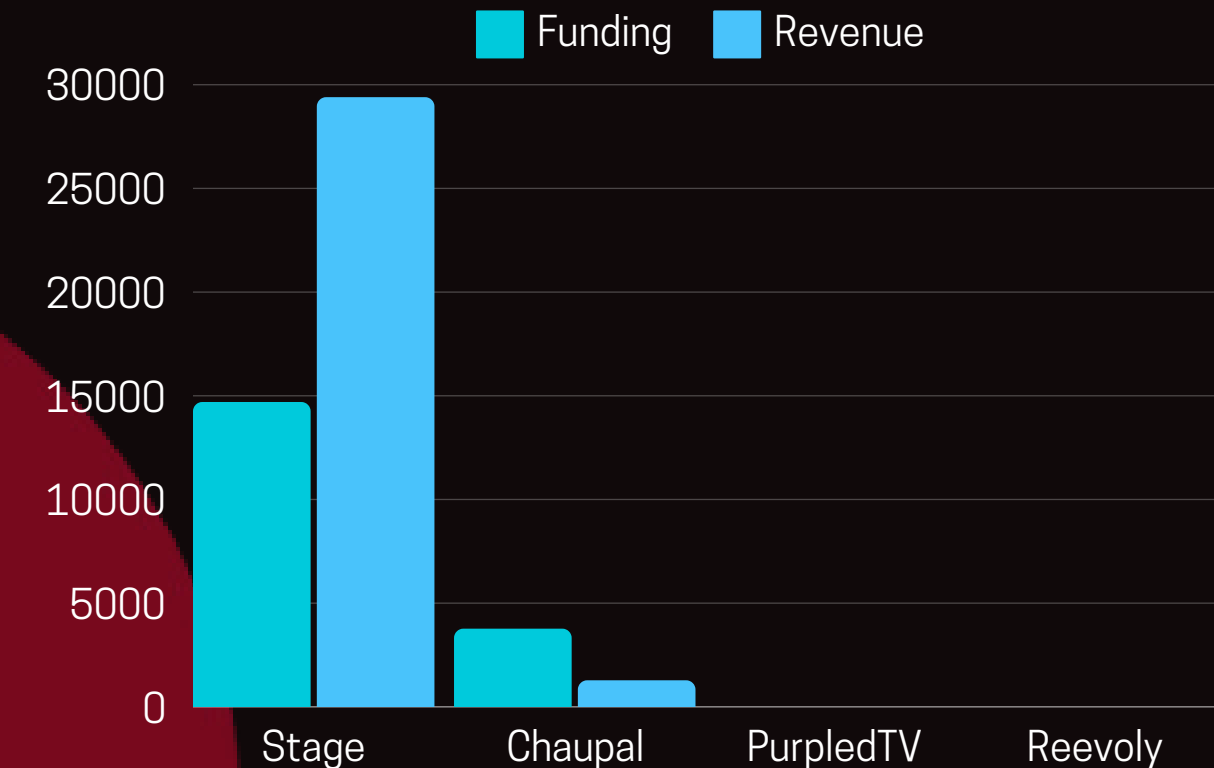
Located in Bengaluru

Company Stage - Unfunded

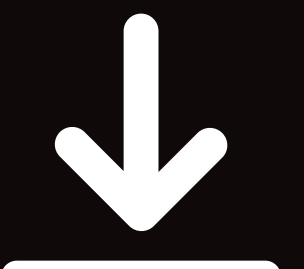
Dialects- Bhojpuri, Maithili.



While Reevoly focuses on niche and independent content, STAGE's success in building a strong community around dialect-specific content gives it a competitive edge in user retention and satisfaction within its target demographic.



Comparison (in K)



Ratings

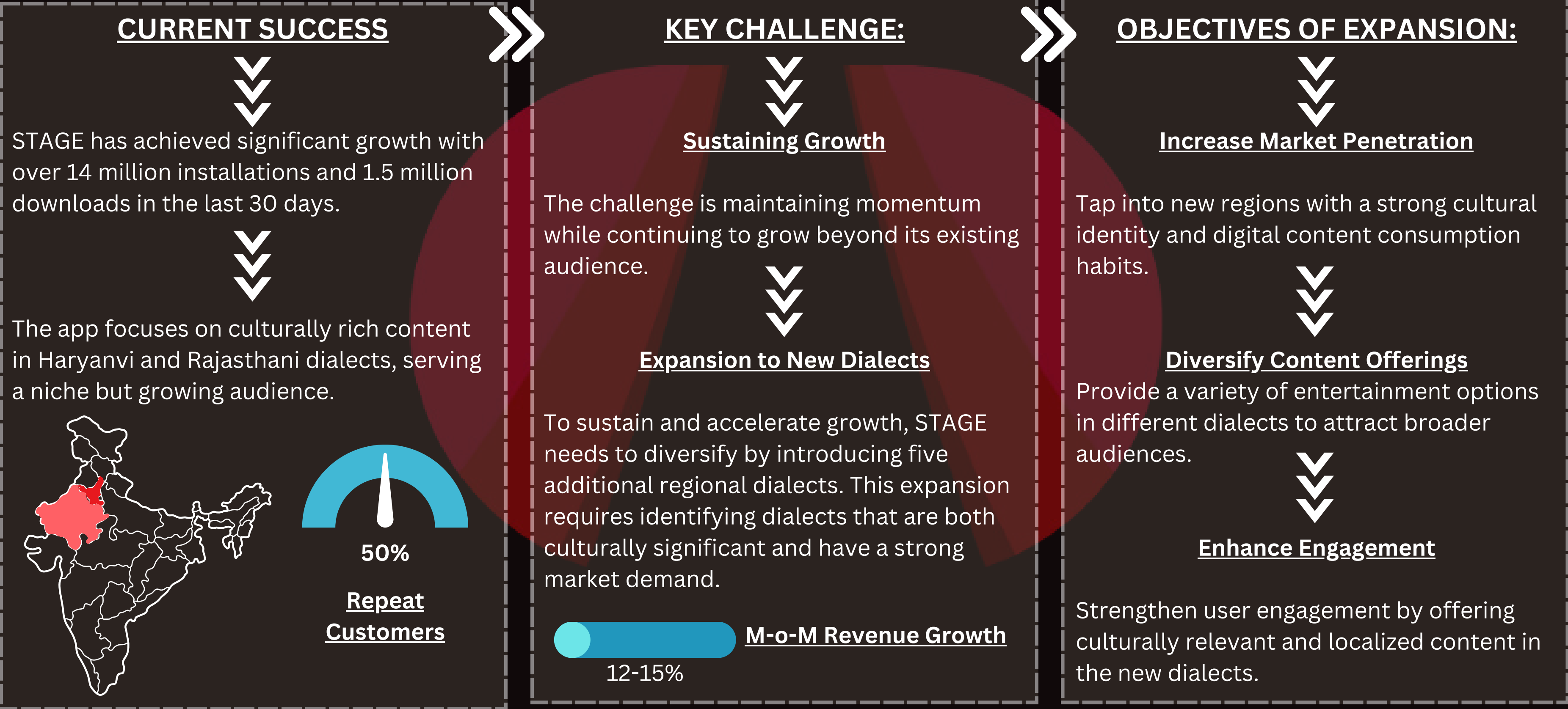
Stage	4.0
Chaupal	3.6
PurpledTV	4.8
Reevoly	4.5

Downloads

Stage	1Cr+
Chaupal	50L+
PurpledTV	1K+
Reevoly	5K+

Expansion Beyond Haryanvi & Rajasthani

Expanding STAGE’s offering to include five additional dialects to sustain and accelerate growth



Identifying High-Growth Regional Dialects for STAGE Expansion

Evaluating Market Potential and Content Demand for Optimal Dialect Selection

CRITERIA FOR SELECTION

Population Size Content Consumption Trends Cultural Engagement

JUSTIFICATION FOR SELECTION



Market Size: The chosen dialects represent large and engaged user bases, offering a substantial market for STAGE’s content.



Content Fit: Each dialect has a rich cultural heritage with content that aligns well with STAGE’s offering of culturally rich entertainment.



Growth Potential: These dialects are in regions with high digital consumption and cultural engagement, ensuring a good fit for STAGE’s expansion strategy.

TOP 5 DIALECTS FOR EXPANSION

BENGALI

- 23 million speakers
- Rich tradition in literature, cinema & music with growing digital consumption

GUJARATI

- 56 million speakers
- Strong preference for regional films, music, & cultural programming

MARATHI

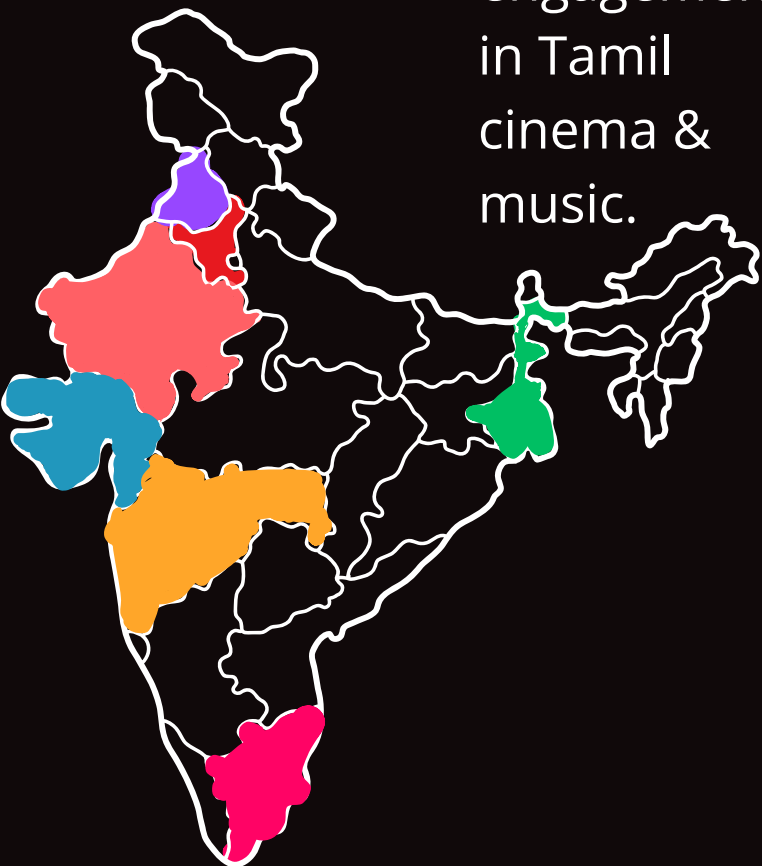
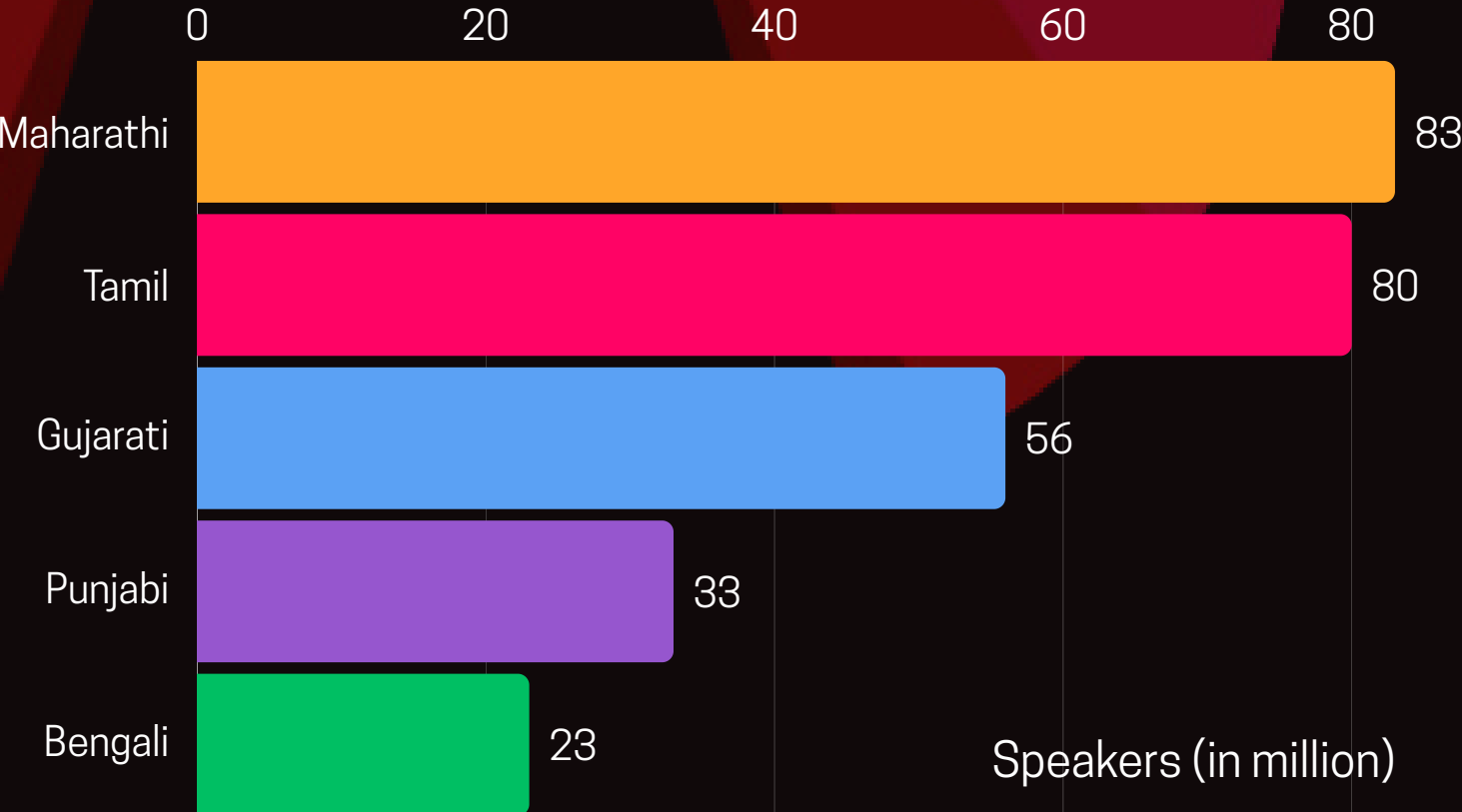
- 83 million speakers.
- High engagement with regional cinema, theater, & television.

PUNJABI

- 33 million speakers.
- High demand for Punjabi music, films, & television.

TAMIL

- 80 million speakers.
- Strong cultural content market with high engagement in Tamil cinema & music.



Audience Reach and Analysis

Understanding the Target Audience for New Dialects

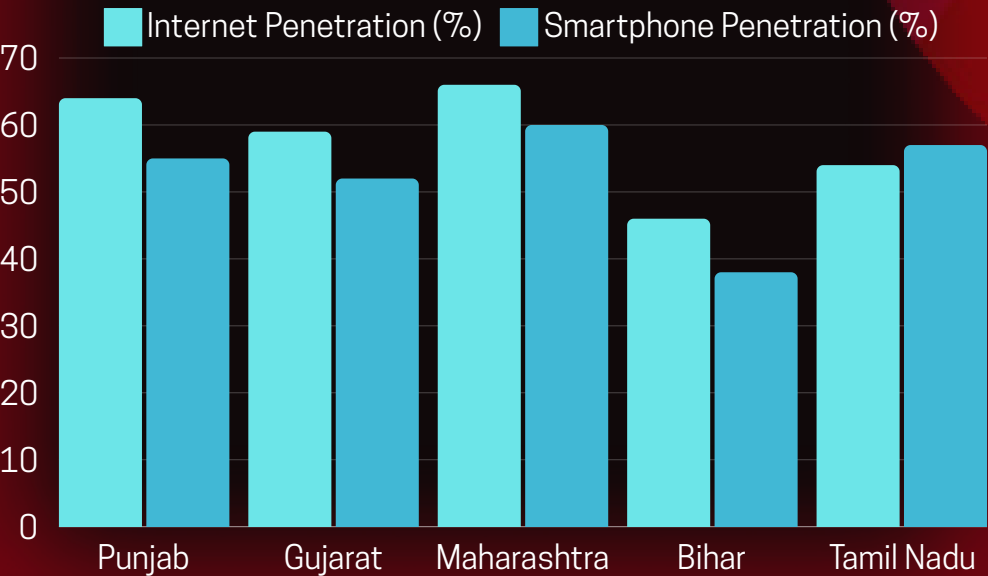
MARKET SIZE

» Estimated Population

Punjabi-speaking : Approx. 33 million
Gujarati-speaking: Approx. 56 million
Marathi-speaking : Approx. 83 million
Bengali-speaking : Approx. 23 million
Tamil-speaking : Approx. 75 million

» Digital Penetration

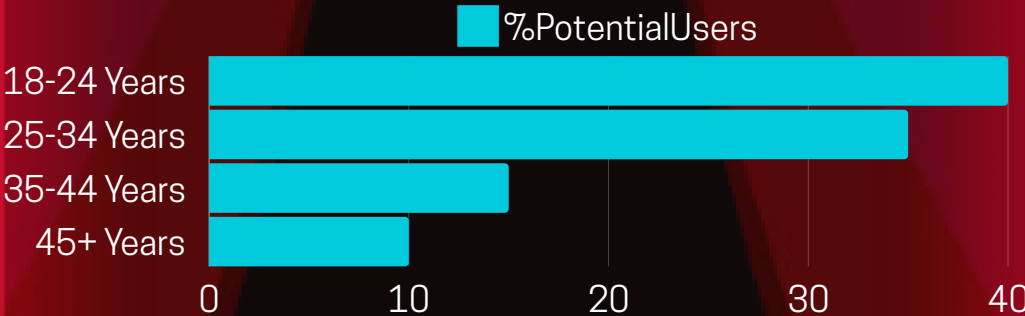
The digital penetration rates indicate strong potential for app adoption



DEMOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

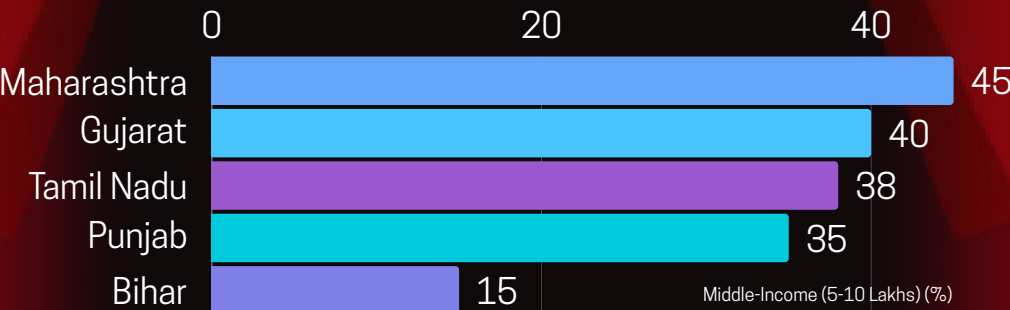
» Age Groups

Breakdown of key age demographics that are likely to engage with entertainment apps:



» Income Levels

Average income levels to determine purchasing power and potential willingness to pay for premium content or in-app purchases.



» Gender Distribution

Male: 52%, Female: 48%



REGIONAL POPULARITY AND PREFERENCES IN TARGET REGIONS

» Popular Content Types

Punjab: Punjabi music, including Bhangra, Stand-up comedy
Gujarat: Traditional folk music, films
Maharashtra: Marathi folk music, Lavani
Bengal: Bengali films and Bollywood cinema
Tamil Nadu: Tamil cinema (Kollywood), traditional Carnatic music

» Cultural Relevance and Significance

Offering exclusive festival-related content could position the app as a culturally aware and locally relevant platform.

Monetization : Seasonal or festival-related content can drive additional revenue through premium content, in-app purchases, or special promotions.

Marketing and Outreach Strategy

Targeting Campaigns and Community Engagement for Regional Expansion



Localized
Marketing
Campaigns



User
Incentives



Performance
Tracking

REGIONAL ADVERTISEMENTS

Digital Ads: Targeted ads on social media platforms & search engines tailored to each region's preferences and languages.

Traditional Media: Utilize regional TV channels, radio stations, and newspapers.

PROMOTIONS AND DISCOUNTS

Free Trials: Offer free trials or limited-time access to premium content in new dialects.

Referral Bonuses: Implement a referral program where existing users can earn rewards for inviting friends and family to try the app.

ANALYTICS AND METRICS

Track Campaign Performance: Use analytics tools to monitor the effectiveness of marketing campaigns, user acquisition, engagement rates, and conversion metrics.

Adjust Strategies: Continuously analyze performance data and adjust marketing strategies.

Influencer Collaborations

Partner with local influencers and content creators popular in each dialect.



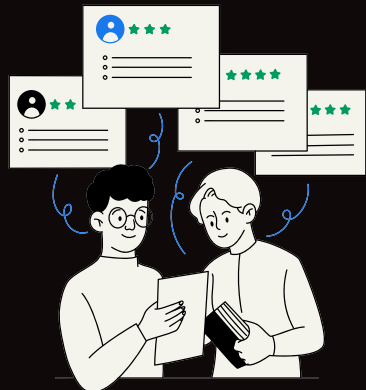
EXCLUSIVE CONTENT

Early Access: Give early access to new dialect content to users who sign up or engage with promotional activities.

Special Releases: Release exclusive or limited-edition content

FEEDBACK COLLECTION

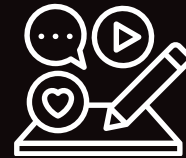
User Surveys
Review Analysis



ENHANCED DIGITAL MARKETING MODEL

To target new customers and improve user experience for onboard users

Personalized Content Marketing



Use advanced algorithm that continues to rearrange the programs overtime on the basis of users viewing history.

Recommendation System- the blend of ML into advertising could drastically enhance Marketing Strategy.

Sharing Account Options



It is one of the rarest features a movie platform can provide. Sharing accounts feature allows spouses, friends, or even groups to share an account with specific filters and preferences already set.

Search Engine Optimization



Use of SEO services for the sake of improving organic research and establishing its brand presence.

Optimize content with potential keywords that show up high in search results.

Enhancing Website



Improving the website's interface to make it more user friendly and interactive.

Content Optimization



Optimize website for content by title, by an actor's name, or even by a director's name. Add a host of personalization features to the website.

Social Media Optimization



To connect with audience in real time, social media is the best platform to establish brand image.

Email Marketing



Can introduce to new users and show relevant recommendations to the old users.

Video Marketing



Utilize platforms like YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels to create engaging short-form video content.



Partnerships and Collaboration

Building Alliances to Enhance Content, Reach, and Engagement

Content Creators and Influencers

Role: Collaborate to produce original content, engage with audiences, and promote the app.

Examples: Regional artists, comedians, musicians, and social media influencers who can help in generating content that resonates with local audiences.



Technology Partners

Role: Provide technological support for app development, content delivery, and user experience enhancements.

Examples: companies specializing in video streaming technology, support for app development.



Media Outlets

Role: Facilitate publicity and promote the app through various media channels.

Examples: Regional newspapers, TV channels, radio stations, and online news platforms.



Educational and Non-Profit Organizations

Role: Collaborate on content that promotes educational or social causes relevant to the target regions.

Examples: NGOs, educational institutions, or community outreach programs.



Strong partnerships and collaborations are crucial for the successful expansion of STAGE into new dialects. They will help in sourcing high-quality content, understanding regional nuances, and effectively reaching and engaging with the target audience.



THANK YOU

Reach Us

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[!\[\]\(8b57f0e15e7dda24cf9977561475f640_img.jpg\) SAMRIDHI](#)

APENDIX

Total Funding

\$14.7M in 11 rounds (7 seed/ 3 early stage/ 1 debt)

Post Money Valuation

\$34.3M (as on Apr 03, 2024)

Investors

183 (62 institutional & 121 Angels)

Ranked

1st among 4 competitors

Annual Revenue

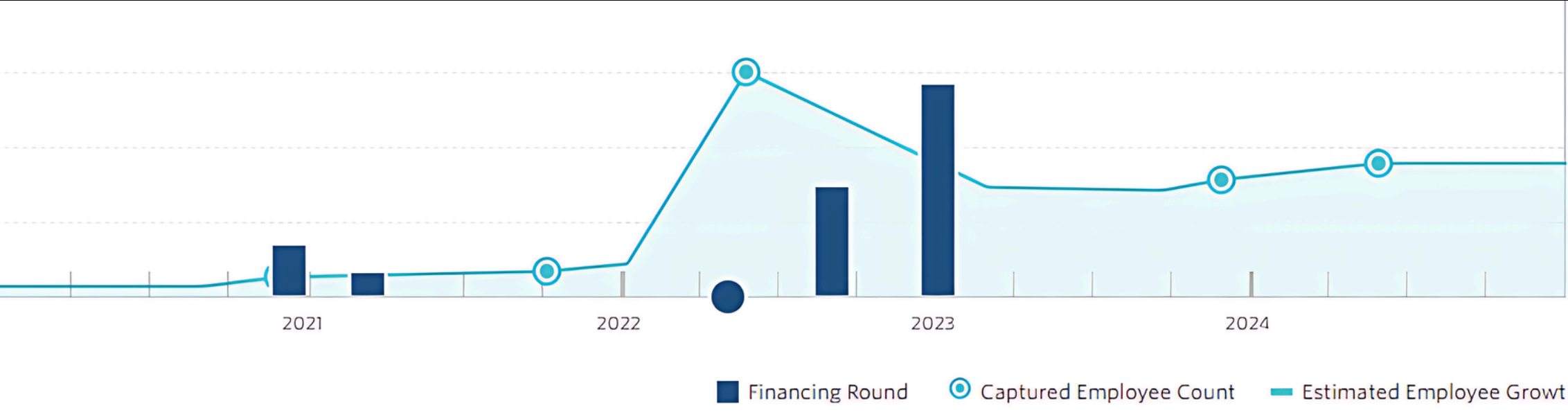
₹2.94Cr (as on Mar 31, 2023)

Employee Count

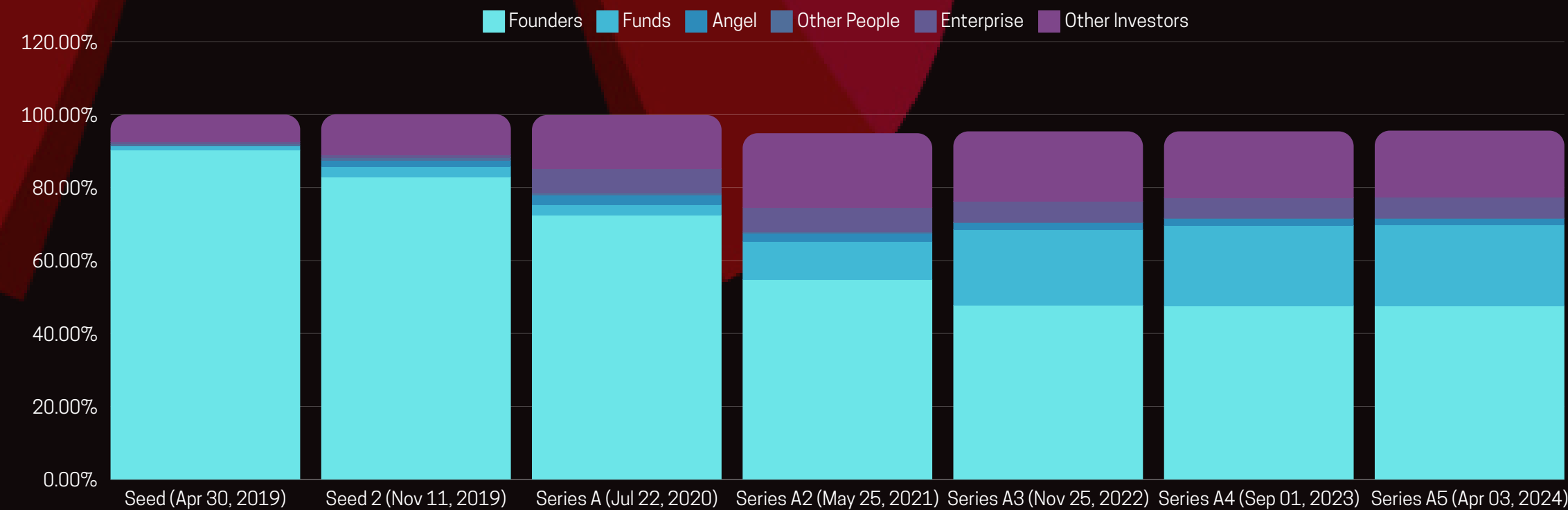
48 (as on Jun 30, 2024)

Legal Entity

STAGE TECHNOLOGY PRIVATE LIMITED & CATCHUP TECHNOLOGY PRIVATED LIMITED



Journey of STAGE



Shareholding of STAGE over the years